



PRODUCT & BUSINESS MODEL

Local skills. Easier to find.

A two-sided marketplace connecting households with local tradespeople—starting in Kigali.

Fundi
Rwanda · Local services

Working concept deck · October 2026

Product overview · Pilot strategy · Revenue hypothesis



Finding reliable help is still too **hard and fragmented**.

The customer problem Fundi is designed to address—hypotheses to validate with Kigali households and tradespeople.

01

Discovery depends on word of mouth

Customers can struggle to find available providers beyond their personal network.

02

Comparisons take effort

Rates, location, experience, and reputation are often difficult to compare in one place.

03

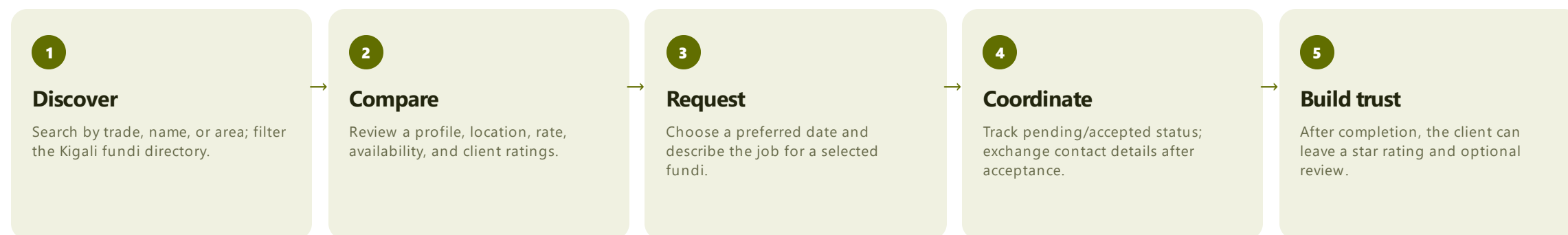
Small providers need reach

Independent fundis need a simple way to present their work and manage incoming requests.

Opportunity: Make local services easier to discover, compare, request, and review—without claiming every provider is already verified.

One simple flow, with value for **both sides**.

The current product is a responsive React marketplace backed by PHP endpoints and JSON-file storage.



Important boundary: The app does not yet process payments, guarantee service quality, provide live chat, or verify provider identity.

Make each side's next step **obvious**.

C
CLIENTS
Find help with more confidence

- ✓ Compare tradespeople in one directory.
- ✓ See listed rates, locations, availability, and review signals.
- ✓ Send and track a booking request.
- ✓ Reveal contact details only after the provider accepts.
- ✓ Review the work after completion.

F
FUNDIS
Turn skills into more opportunities

- ✓ Create a trade profile with a short bio.
- ✓ Set a rate and availability.
- ✓ Accept, decline, and manage requests.
- ✓ Build a public reputation through client reviews.
- ✓ Exchange contact details with clients on accepted work.

Marketplace flywheel

More reliable supply → better selection → more completed jobs → stronger reviews → more customer confidence.

Proposed growth loop

Start focused: prove a dense, dependable **Kigali** marketplace.

A practical launch wedge is one city, a few high-frequency trades, and carefully chosen neighbourhoods.

WHERE

Kigali first

Concentrate demand and provider availability before expanding to other cities.

WHO

Households & small businesses

People who need local repair, improvement, tailoring, or maintenance work.

SUPPLY

Independent fundis

Electricians, plumbers, carpenters, tailors, and adjacent service providers.

WEDGE

Quality before breadth

Recruit responsive providers in selected areas; expand as service density grows.

4 trades

shown in the current demo directory

Kigali

initial product geography

0 market-size claims

validate demand before sizing expansion

Market sizing next step: estimate the reachable market bottom-up using target neighbourhoods × active providers × monthly jobs × average job value. Treat these as research inputs, not current traction.

Earn when a job is completed—not just when a lead is sent.

Recommended direction for testing; this is a proposed business model, not a feature currently implemented.

CORE MODEL TO TEST

Transparent commission on completed work

Keep basic discovery and profiles free during the pilot. Once customers and fundis confirm value, test a modest fee on platform-attributed completed jobs.

LATER, IF EARNED

Optional provider tools

Consider paid visibility or a provider subscription only after proving that listings generate incremental, quality work. Keep ranking fair and label promotions.

ILLUSTRATIVE UNIT ECONOMICS

RWF 5,000

Example fee at a hypothetical 10% on a RWF 50,000 completed job.

Not a forecast. Validate fee acceptance, average job value, completion tracking, payment costs, taxes, and support costs before setting pricing.

Current limitation: Payments and commission collection are not built. Contact is shared after acceptance, so off-platform completion and revenue leakage are real risks.

Build local density before broad awareness.

A lean pilot can test both marketplace sides and reveal where trust or fulfillment breaks down.

01

Recruit supply

Interview fundis, explain the value exchange, help create accurate profiles, and agree a clear response standard.

02

Seed neighborhood demand

Start with community referrals, local groups, property managers, and small-business partnerships.

03

Follow every request

Manually learn why requests are accepted, declined, delayed, completed, or abandoned.

PILOT EXPERIMENT

One neighborhood × two or three trades

Recruit a small cohort (for example, 20–30 providers as a test target) and measure active, responsive supply—not signup count alone.

LEARNING LOOP

Interview both sides weekly

Ask clients about trust, price clarity, and outcomes; ask fundis about lead quality, effort, earnings, and repeat use.

Trust is the product—and the work behind it.

ALREADY IN THE APP

Useful trust signals

- ✓ Public profiles, listed rates, location, and availability.
- ✓ Booking status and client reviews after completion.
- ✓ Contact details shared only on an accepted booking.

BEFORE A PUBLIC PILOT

Operational trust to build

- ✓ Provider identity/skill checks and a transparent verification label.
- ✓ Clear cancellation, complaint, and dispute-handling policy.
- ✓ Support escalation, safety guidance, and review moderation.
- ✓ Consent, contact-data retention, and privacy controls.

Scale readiness: The current PHP + JSON setup is suitable for a prototype/demo, not production marketplace volume. Add robust authentication, authorization, auditability, backups, and scalable storage before launch.



Learn, prove fulfillment, then automate.

0–30 DAYS • DISCOVERY

Validate the pain

Interview households and fundis; map current discovery and payment behavior; confirm first trades and neighborhoods.

Output: pilot scope, trust checklist, pricing hypotheses.

30–90 DAYS • CONCIERGE PILOT

Prove successful matches

Recruit and coach a small cohort; track response, acceptance, completion, issues, repeat use, and willingness to pay.

Output: evidence for marketplace liquidity and economics.

90+ DAYS • PRODUCTIZE

Invest based on evidence

Prioritize payment/fee flow, messaging, provider verification, support tooling, and better operational analytics.

Output: a safer and more measurable service marketplace.

Core scorecard: time to first response · request acceptance rate · completed-job rate · cancellation/dispute rate · repeat booking · active fundis · client and provider satisfaction · contribution margin.



A FOCUSED PILOT CAN ANSWER THE BIG QUESTIONS.

Can Fundi make local work easier to find —and better to deliver?

Start with one Kigali neighborhood, a dependable group of fundis, and a measurable set of completed jobs.

Pilot objective: prove trust · match quality · repeat value

Fundi
Local skills. Easier to find.

Business model and market assumptions are hypotheses for validation.